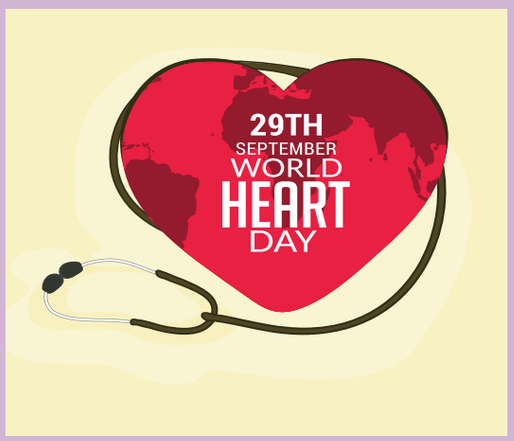
SUMMARY

- Hypertension (high blood pressure) is a major risk factor for CVD. Hypertension is usually asymptomatic until complications develop.
- Excessive bodyweight, lack of physical activity, excessive consumption of alcohol and sodium, and a low intake of potassium are factors that increase the risk of hypertension.
- Prolonged hypertension damages the cardiovascular system, brain, and kidneys, increasing risk of myocardial infarction, stroke, and renal failure.
- Treatment involves lifestyle changes together with dietary intervention.
- CVD is the major cause of death worldwide. It is a disease that affects the blood vessels.
- Primary prevention can be achieved by targeting cardiovascular risk factors such as hyperlipidaemia, hypertension, and diabetes mellitus.
- Weight control, healthy diet and physical activity are the three focus areas in the prevention and management of CVD.



A-Z GLOSSARY

Atherosclerosis	A disease of the arteries characterized by the deposition of fatty material on their inner walls
Hypertension	Abnormally high blood pressure.
Plaque	Plaque is made up of fat, cholesterol, calcium, and other substances found in the blood. This builds up inside the arteries.
LDL	Bad cholesterol. Transports cholesterol to the tissues. Leads to atherosclerosis.
HDL	Good Cholesterol. Carries cholesterol from other parts of the body back to the liver. Prevents atherosclerosis.
Essential hypertension	Essential hypertension (also called primary hypertension or idiopathic hypertension) is the form of hypertension that has no identifiable cause

UNIT - 11.indd 188 25-02-2019 15:38:25